



## Many servers still vulnerable

After the Heartbleed vulnerability was made public about two months ago, many servers haven't been patched yet <http://dgit.in/1nuCq8m>



## Kevlar inventor passes away

Saving countless lives, Stephanie Kwolek who invented Kevlar dies at 90 <http://dgit.in/11JDx5H>

Bazaar

# BlackBerry Z3

## BlackBerry impresses in the mid-range

The BlackBerry Z3 makes its way towards the market at a time when phone manufacturers, after focusing on the top-end for much too long, have realised the importance of the budget/mid-range segment. We got a 'pre-launch' test unit of the Z3 which, we were assured, was very similar to the launch model.

### Design & Build

Even if you're not a fan of BlackBerry phones, you would be hard-pressed to deny that the Z3 is one of the best built and premium looking phones at its price. The Z3 isn't the slimmest phone but despite its thickness and overall size, the phone feels relatively light, its 164 grams not really making it bulky or difficult to handle. The Z3 is large and its build quality is firm and sturdy despite relying exclusively on plastic. The Z3 has a textured non-removable back panel that helps you keep a grip on the phone. The device looks good and chances are that people's guesses about its price will be a lot higher than the actual price-tag.

The Z3's 5-inch screen is colourful, accurate but it is shackled by a resolution of 960x540 pixels. This is understandable because of the phone's price but at times five inches does seem like too much real estate for that resolution to cover. Nothing to complain about the screen apart from the fact that it does tend to lose visibility under direct sunlight.

### Features

BB10 has been around for a while and if you've already made up your mind about it, then this won't really change your mind. BB10, on the Z3, remains a mobile OS that focuses primarily on communication, be it through emails, messages, on Facebook or Twitter or phone calls. As a result, the phone lets you access all of the aforementioned quickly from anywhere in the phone, even if you're inside an app through the 'Hub' that can be accessed by swiping to the right on the homescreen and upwards and to the right inside any app.

You'll have to rely on either the BlackBerry World app store or a third party Android app store for your apps. In the case of the former, you will get plenty of apps but you may come across some big missing names. In the case of the latter, you will be able to install almost any Android app but you can't be 100% sure if the app works. For instance, we installed Dead Trigger 2 (from the 1Mobile Market

app store) but the game wouldn't run.

### Performance and Usability

The Z3's performance is smooth and lag-free throughout including when switching to and between apps or browsing the Web. One issue that crops up is that because of its large size, swipe gestures that require you to swipe from the edge of the screen become difficult unless you have particularly large hands. In that way, the Z3 requires two-handed operation more times than not.

The Z3's 5MP camera continues BlackBerry's tradition of packing in unimpressive shooters in their phones. On the plus side, the camera launches quickly and takes little time to shoot multiple photos. There are also built-in filters and editing options to 'improve' captured photos which works pretty well.

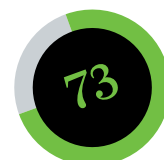
The Z3 impresses with its battery life and we saw the phone last for nearly a day and a half of use which consisted of phone calls, time on Facebook, about 20 mins of gaming and camera use. Another thing that impressed us was the Z3's keyboard which remains one of the best touchscreen keyboards in the business.

The Z3's speaker was surprisingly soft during calls but reproduced music well. The Z3 is a good phone for music especially since it makes buying music from the BlackBerry World store so easy.

### Bottomline

The BlackBerry Z3 makes a strong case for the Canadian phone maker in the mid-range segment. It's worth recommending at ₹16k for its large screen, although a lower price would have made it a much better deal. At about ₹16.5k, the BlackBerry Z10 is a significantly better buy if you're okay with its 4.2-in screen. You can also consider the Motorola Moto G and the Nokia Lumia 720.

Nikhil Pradban



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|-----------------------|----|
| Features .....        | 65 |
| Performance .....     | 75 |
| Build Quality .....   | 75 |
| Value for money ..... | 75 |

### Specifications

**Operating System:** BlackBerry 10.2.1; **Screen Size:** 5-in at 960x540 pixels; **Built-In Storage:** 8GB; **MicroSD Card Support:** Upto 32GB; **RAM:** 1.5GB; **Camera:** 5MP; **Wi-Fi:** Wi-Fi 802.11 b/g/n; **Bluetooth:** v4.0 with A2DP; **Battery:** 2500mAh; **Processor:** 1.2GHz dual-core Snapdragon 400

### Contact

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